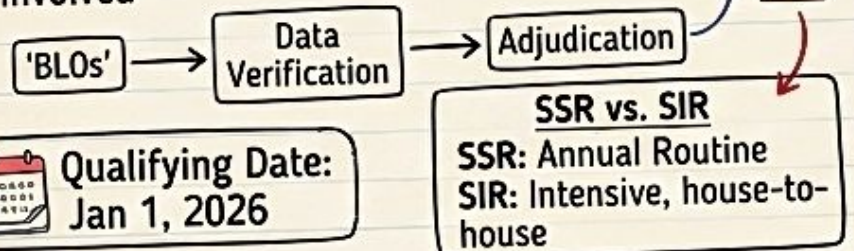


POLITY & GOVERNANCE: PRELIMS REVISION

1. SIR: ECI Exercise (2026)

- **SPECIAL INTENSIVE REVISION (SIR):** West Bengal
- **Objective:** PURIFY electoral rolls
- **Scale:** DELETED over 90.66 LAKH "discrepant" voters
- **Causes:** Death, Migration, Duplication
- **Key Mechanism:** 100% Physical Verification by Booth Level Officers (BLOs)
- **Judicial Oversight:** over 700 Judicial Officers involved



Quick Comparison Table for Revision

Feature	Details
SIR 2026 (WB)	Special Intensive Revision: STATUTORY RIGHT , 1951; can be regulated by State.
Right to Vote	Constitution: Derived from Art. 326 .
PIL Origin	Concept: Relaxes <i>Locus Standi</i> rules.
Locus Standi	Filing: Under Art. 32 (SC) or Art. 226 (HC)

2. Right to Vote: Judicial Classification

- **SC RULING (April 2026):** A **STATUTORY RIGHT** but not a Fundamental Right
- **Constitutional Basis:** Derived from **Art. 326**
- **STATUTORY NATURE:** Created by R.P. Act, 1950 & 1951; can be regulated by State

Right to Vote:
Participate in process

Right to Contest:
'Distinct & Additional' right, stricter qualifications

3. PIL: Process & Debates

- **Origin:** Judicial Innovation by **J. P.N. Bhagwati & J. V.R. Krishna Iyer**
- **Definition:** Any public-spirited citizen can file for marginalized sections.
- **Concept:** Relaxes *Locus Standi* rules.
- **Filing:** Under **Art. 32** (SC) or **Art. 226** (HC)
- **2026 Context:** Stricter scrutiny, imposing fines on 'busybody' litigants.

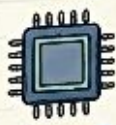


ABHISHA AI
by Abhishek Pathak

UPSC PRELIMS 2026: KEY TOPICS - ABHISHA AI

1. INDUSTRIAL CORRIDORS & LOGISTICS

A. DHOLERA SIR & SEMICONDUCTOR SEZ



- INDIA'S FIRST SEMICONDUCTOR SEZ, APPROVED 2026
- CHIP FABRICATION PLANT (FAB) NOTIFIED BY GOVERNMENT
- LOCATED IN DHOLERA SPECIAL INVESTMENT REGION (SIR), GUJARAT
- OPERATED BY TATA SEMICONDUCTOR MANUFACTURING PVT LTD
- INFRASTRUCTURE: ~66 HECTARES FOR ELECTRONICS HARDWARE, SOFTWARE, IT/ITES



NOTE: FOLLOWS 2025 AMENDMENT TO SEZ RULES (2006): MINIMUM LAND FOR SEMICONDUCTOR UNITS REDUCED TO 10 HECTARES FROM 50 HECTARES TO ENCOURAGE HIGH-TECH CLUSTERS

B. DELHI-DEHRADUN ECONOMIC CORRIDOR



- INAUGURATED/FINAL STAGES, APRIL 2026
- LENGTH: 213 KM
- REDUCES TRAVEL TIME: 6 HOURS TO 2.5 HOURS
- KEY FEATURE: 12-KM ELEVATED WILDLIFE CORRIDOR (ONE OF ASIA'S LONGEST) OVER SHIVALIK FORESTS



C. LOGISTICS: INDIA'S AVIATION PUSH



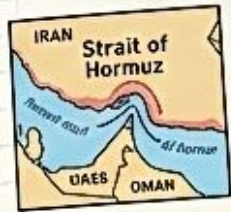
- INDIA BECOMES WORLD'S 3RD LARGEST DOMESTIC AVIATION MARKET (AS OF MARCH 2026)
- DRIVEN BY UDAN SCHEME (UDE DESH KA AAM NAAGRIK) AND DAILY PASSENGERS > 5 LAKH



BY ABHISHEK PATHAK

2. GEOPOLITICS & INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

A. WEST ASIA CRISIS & INDIA'S STRATEGIC AUTONOMY



- CRISIS FOLLOWED US-ISRAELI STRIKES ON IRANIAN LEADERSHIP (EARLY 2026)
- IRAN DECLARES STRAIT OF HORMUZ 'SHUT' (MARCH 2026)
- IMPACT ON INDIA: SOARING INSURANCE COSTS, PHYSICAL RISKS TO INDIAN-FLAGGED VESSELS (INDIA IS A MAJOR OIL IMPORTER)
- INDIA'S STRATEGIC RESPONSE: MAINTAINED STRATEGIC AUTONOMY, DEMANDED 'UNIMPEDED FREEDOM OF NAVIGATION', PARTICIPATED IN MARITIME SECURITY CONF. WHILE AVOIDING FORMAL MILITARY ALLIANCES

B. INDIA'S OUTREACH (2026)



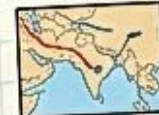
- STATE VISIT TO ISRAEL (FEB 2026): UPGRADED TO 'SPECIAL STRATEGIC PARTNERSHIP FOR PEACE, INNOVATION & PROSPERITY'. FOCUS: AI, SEMICONDUCTORS, QUANTUM COMPUTING
- STRATEGIC RESET WITH CANADA: FOCUS ON ECONOMIC FUNDAMENTALS (CRITICAL MINERALS, PULSES)
- STRATEGIC RESET WITH FINLAND: STRENGTHENING DIGITAL PARTNERSHIP (6G, SUSTAINABILITY)

C. TRADE MULTILATERALISM: INDIA'S OPPOSITION TO WTO'S IFD AGREEMENT



- IFD = INVESTMENT FACILITATION FOR DEVELOPMENT
- INDIA'S ARGUMENTS:
 - NON-TRADE ISSUE: WTO MANDATE IS TRADE, NOT FDI.
 - SOVEREIGNTY: IFD RULES (E.G., PRE-INVESTMENT APPEAL) ERODE 'POLICY SPACE' TO REGULATE FDI.
 - PLURILATERALISM: OPPOSES 'COALITION OF WILLING', ARGUES IT UNDERMINES CONSENSUS-BASED MULTILATERALISM

D. STRATEGIC CORRIDORS: INSTC & IMEC



- INSTC (INTERNATIONAL NORTH-SOUTH TRANSPORT CORRIDOR): RENEWED FOCUS AS 'SANCTIONS-PROOF' ROUTE (INDIA-IRAN-RUSSIA/CENTRAL ASIA VIA BANDAR ABBAS)
- IMEC (INDIA-MIDDLE EAST-EUROPE ECONOMIC CORRIDOR): STILL PRIORITY DESPITE VOLATILITY FOR LONG-TERM DIVERSIFICATION. AIMS: REDUCE LOGISTICS COSTS BY 30%, TRANSIT TIME BY 40%

UPSC PRELIMS 'CATCH' POINTS

DHOLERA: GREENFIELD INDUSTRIAL CITY.

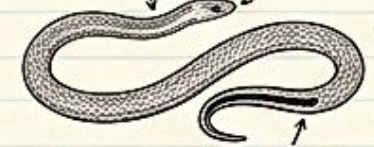
HORMUZ: GEOGRAPHY - CONNECTS PERSIAN GULF WITH GULF OF OMAN & ARABIAN SEA.

IFD: DISTINGUISH MULTILATERAL (ALL MEMBERS) VS. PLURILATERAL (SOME MEMBERS) AGREEMENTS.

I. NEWLY DISCOVERED SPECIES (2025-26)

1. *Calamaria garoensis* (Garo Hills Reed Snake)

Location: Ourrowing, Burrowing burrowisls
Burrowing feat stures



Features: 13 smooth dorsal scales, Short blunt tail with black stripe

- Location: Oragitok, West Garo Hills, Meghalaya (near Nokrek BR)
- Features: Fossorial (burrowing), 13 rows smooth dorsal scales, Short blunt tail with black stripe
- Note: Distinct from *C. pavementata* via genetic analysis.
- Status: **Proposed Vulnerable**

2. *Cyrtodactylus raimonaensis* (Raimona Bent-toed Gecko)



- Location: Raimona National Park, Assam (Kokrajhar district)
- Features: 'Bent-toed' gecko, evolutionary adaptation for grip in tropical forests.
- Note: Part of Indo-Burma Biodiversity Hotspot & transboundary corridor with Bhutan.

3. *Tenkana jayamangali* (Jumping Spider)



- Location: Jayamangali River area, Karnataka
- Genus 'Tenkana': Named after 'South' (Kannada)
- Note: Drier, ground-level habitats in Southern India (KA, TN, AP). Distinct from forest-dwelling spiders.

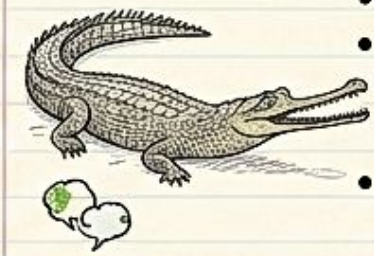


QUICK MAPPING FOR PRELIMS

Species	Location	Threat	Status
Gharial	Chambal	Dronegrinding	Vulnerable
GIB	Assam	Endangered	None
Olive Ridley	Olive Ridley	Endangered	None
Reed Snake	West Garo	Endangered	None

II. CONSERVATION LANDMARKS (2025-26)

1. GHARIAL (*Gavialis gangeticus*)



- Stronghold: Chambal River (~2100 individuals)
- Indicator: Top predator, denotes clean river health.
- Status: IUCN: **Critically Endangered**
- Update: Rajasthan denotified 732 hectares, but core breeding areas remain protected.

2. GREAT INDIAN BUSTARD (GIB)



- Threat: Fatal collisions with overhead power lines (poor frontal vision, heavy body)
- IUCN: **Critically Endangered**
- landmark SC Verdict (Dec 2025): Mandates undergrounding power lines in priority habitats (RJ, GJ). Priority to GIB over renewable energy expansion.

3. OLIVE RIDLEY TURTLES (*Lepidochelys olivacea*)



- Arribada: Mass nesting at Gahirmatha Marine Sanctuary, Odisha (world's largest site)
- IUCN: Vulnerable; WPA Sch-I
- Measures: Operation Olivia (Coast Guard), mandatory Turtle Excluder Devices (TEDs).

CONSERVATION LAND MARKS (2025 PRELIMS)

UPSC PRELIMS 2026: LATEST SCI-TECH & ENV FACTSHEET

KEY EMERGING DEVELOPMENTS

EMERGING TECH & ECONOMY

Amaravati Quantum Reference Facility (AQRF)

- India's first open-access, indigenous quantum testbed
- Uses Diamond-based Quantum Computing (Nitrogen-Vacancy centers)
- Operates at near absolute zero (-273°C)
- Core validation hub for qubits & cryo-systems under NQM

India Semiconductor Mission (ISM) 2.0

- Announced in Budget 2026-27 (₹1,000 crore)
- Focus: Deepen technological sovereignty, shift to full Indian Semiconductor IP, equipment & material science
- Target: \$110B market by 2030

National Nuclear Energy Mission Scaling

- Goal: Scale from ~8 GW to 100 GW by 2047
- Small Modular Reactors (SMRs) prioritized
- SHANTI Act (2025) allows private/foreign investment
- Three-Stage Program: PI → U-233, ultimately utilizing Thorium

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BIODIVERSITY & NEW DISCOVERIES

Species	Type	Location	Unique Fact
<i>Bridgeoporus kanadai</i>	Macro Fungi	Arunachal Pradesh	Massive wood-rotting fungus; largest specimens >3m radius.
<i>Neelus sikkimensis</i>	Springtail	Sikkim	Tiny, soil-dwelling micro-arthropod at high altitudes.
<i>Dolomedes indicus</i>	Fishing Spider	Kerala	First confirmed Indian species. Semi-aquatic ambush predator, senses water ripples.
<i>Rhinophis siruvaniensis</i>	Shieldtail Snake	Siruvani Hills	Burrowing snake, endemic to wet evergreen forests.

HEALTH & BIOPHARMA

Biopharma SHAKTI

- ₹10,000 crore mission (5 yrs)
- Aims to make India a global Biologics & Biosimilars hub
- Upgrading NIPERs
- Stronger CDSCO with Scientific Review Cadre

Adult TB Vaccine Debate

- PreVenTB trial (2026): VPM1002 candidate showed limited pulmonary TB protection (~20%), but notable against Extrapulmonary TB (~65%).
- Chagas Disease: Management crucial
- Caused by parasite *Trypanosoma cruzi* globally, potentially transmitted via blood

CARBON MARKETS

India's Carbon Credit Trading Scheme

- Now operational
- Governance: Ministry of Power & MoEFCC co-chair
- Lead Admin: Bureau of Energy Efficiency (BEE)
- Registry: Grid Controller of India Ltd.

Compliance

- Seven sectors (Cement, Steel)
- Trade Carbon Credit Certificates (CCC) based on exceeding Greenhouse Gas Emission Intensity (GEI) targets.
- Market-based mechanism to reduce emissions.

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UPSC PRELIMS 2026: STRATEGIC & GEOPOLITICAL AFFAIRS

★ BRICS+ EXPANSION & INDIA'S ROLE

✓ 17TH BRICS SUMMIT (RIO DE JANEIRO, 2025)

- Host: Brazil
- Expansion focus
- Inclusive global governance



✓ 18TH BRICS SUMMIT (INDIA, 2026)

- India as Chair
- Priorities: UN Reforms, Counter-Terrorism
- Digital Public Infrastructure, South-South Cooperation



★ IORA CHAIRSHIP (2025-27) - INDIA

★ Prime objective: Promoting maritime security & safety

- Sustainable Blue Economy
- Disaster Risk Management
- Academic Cooperation



✓ Key principle: "SAGAR" (Security and Growth for All in the Region)

★ Key principles: (sea & rail)

- Joint investments
- Food security
- Space exploration
- Game-changer for trade



★ STRATEGIC CORRIDORS: I2U2 & IMEC

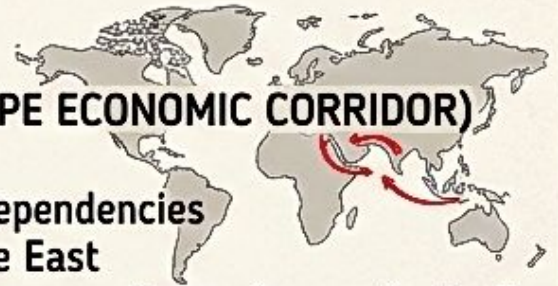
✓ I2U2 GROUP (India, Israel, USA, UAE)



- Joint investments
- Food security
- Space exploration

✓ IMEC (INDIA-MIDDLE EAST-EUROPE ECONOMIC CORRIDOR)

- Multimodal link (sea & rail)
- Counter to global supply chain dependencies
- Connectivity from India to Middle East (UAE, Saudi, Jordan, Israel) to Europe - Game-changer for trade



★ CHENAB RAILWAY BRIDGE & MAP LOCATIONS

✓ CHENAB BRIDGE (J&K)

- World's highest railway arch bridge over the Chenab River
- ✓ Integrates Kashmir Valley with the national grid
- ✓ Height: 359m (higher than Eiffel Tower)
- ✓ All-weather connectivity



★ KEY MAP LOCATIONS

✓ SCARBOROUGH SHOAL

- Disputed in the South
- Tensions involving China and the Philippines



✓ ANDAMAN SEA

- Strategic chokepoint, connects to Malacca Strait



✓ POTOMAC RIVER

- Flows into Chesapeake Bay, USA
- Location of Washington D.C.



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